

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1974 RECOMMENDATION CONCERNING EDUCATION FOR INTERNATIONAL UNDERSTANDING, CO-OPERATION AND PEACE AND EDUCATION RELATING TO HUMAN RIGHTS AND FUNDAMENTAL FREEDOMS

I. Introduction

A. About the 1974 Recommendation

1. UNESCO's 1974 *Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms*¹ (the "1974 Recommendation") aims to promote international education and world peace through understanding, solidarity and cooperation. It was adopted on 19 November 1974 by the General Conference of UNESCO at its 18th session.

2. The 1974 *Recommendation* applies to formal, non-formal and informal education and to all levels, from pre-primary to tertiary and adult education and lifelong learning. The General Conference recommended "*that Member States should apply*" the provisions included in the 1974 *Recommendation* "*by taking whatever legislative or other steps*" that provide institutional (e.g. policies and legal frameworks) and pedagogical (e.g. curricula, teacher training, educational materials, equipment, and student assessment) support for its implementation, based on the "*objectives*", referred to in paragraph 4 of the 1974 *Recommendation*, "*regarded as major guiding principles of education policy*" including: an international dimension and a global perspective on education, cultural diversity, interdependence, communication, rights and responsibilities, international solidarity and cooperation, and problem solving.

3. Today, the principles of the 1974 *Recommendation* apply equally well to Education for Sustainable Development (ESD) and to Global Citizenship Education (GCED) and therefore represent a powerful tool for promoting the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and in particular SDG Target 4.7 on the promotion of sustainable development and global citizenship through education, Target 12.8 on access to information on sustainable development and Target 13.3 on climate change education.

4. The General Conference in its 39th session recommended the use of the 1974 *Recommendation* reporting process to support the implementation and monitoring of Target 4.7 of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (39 C/Resolution 79). The UNESCO Executive Board at its 209th session approved the use of the current guidelines for both the monitoring of the 1974 *Recommendation* and the collection of data needed for the following global SDG indicator for which UNESCO is custodian (209 EX/Decision 18.II):

4.7.1, 12.8.1 and 13.3.1: *The extent to which (i) global citizenship education and (ii) education for sustainable development are mainstreamed in (a) national education policies; (b) curricula; (c) teacher education and (d) student assessment.*

5. Questions marked with an asterisk (*) will be used in the calculation of the respective indicators (**Table 1**). As approved by the Inter-Agency and Expert Group on the SDG Indicators, the indicators will be calculated for primary and secondary education only.

Table 1 Questions used in the calculation of the global SDG indicator for Targets 4.7, 12.8 and 13.3

Policies	Curricula	Teacher education	Student assessment
A2, A4, A5, E1a	B2, B3, B4, E1b	C2, C3, C4, C5, E1c	D2, D3, E1d

¹ http://portal.unesco.org/en/ev.php-URL_ID=13088&URL_DO=DO_TOPIC&URL_SECTION=201.html

B. Reporting obligations

6. The General Conference, at its 18th session, when adopting the *1974 Recommendation* recommended “*that Member States submit [...] reports concerning the action taken by them in pursuance of this recommendation*”. Moreover, in accordance with Article VIII of UNESCO’s Constitution “*Each Member State shall submit to the Organization [...] reports [...] on the action taken upon the recommendations and conventions referred to in Article IV, paragraph 4.*”

7. Thus, **all UNESCO Member States are expected to report on the steps they have taken to implement the 1974 Recommendation** preferably by completing the following questionnaire. Such reporting takes place every four years.

II. Guidelines for completion of the questionnaire

8. This questionnaire and its accompanying guidelines are addressed to Ministers responsible for relations with UNESCO. The questionnaire is typically completed by Ministries of Education and other government authorities responsible for education. Responses should cover, as far as possible, education at all levels of government, including sub-national levels where applicable as well as education outside the government sector.

9. National respondents are encouraged to **consult widely** both within, across and beyond government, including with Ministries of Environment, with national human rights institutions, the education sector, civil society partners and others, as necessary, to gather the information needed to complete the questionnaire.

10. Responses to the seventh consultation should cover:

- (i) the time period 2017-2020;
- (ii) education at all levels of formal education from pre-primary to tertiary education as well as non-formal education;
- (iii) all levels of government that have responsibility for education within the country; and
- (iv) where possible, education outside the government sector.

11. To assist countries in responding to this questionnaire, UNESCO has developed the following set of global citizenship education and education for sustainable development themes. The list is based on a review of current common practices in many countries as well as a review of relevant literature. While the terms ESD and GCED may be used differently in some countries, the list of themes typically captures what are seen as key elements of Target 4.7. Please refer to the definitions of key terms in **Section III** before completing the questionnaire.

Global citizenship education and education for sustainable development

- 1. cultural diversity and tolerance
 - 1.1 international or intercultural understanding, solidarity and cooperation
 - 1.2 intercultural and interreligious dialogue
 - 1.3 local, national and/or global citizenship
- 2. gender equality education
 - 2.1 gender-based equal opportunities
 - 2.2 gender equality and justice
 - 2.3 gender roles, identity and stereotypes

3. human rights education
 - 3.1 equality and non-discrimination based on race, colour, language, religion, disability, political or other opinion, national or social origin, birth or other status
 - 3.2 human rights values, human dignity, justice, inclusion and participation
 - 3.3 respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (as outlined in international conventions and declarations)
4. peace and non-violence
 - 4.1 friendly relations among peoples and nations
 - 4.2 challenging negative stereotypes, promoting peaceful solutions, learning to live together, including others and preventing violent extremism
 - 4.3 preventing all forms of violence including bullying, verbal abuse and gender-based violence
5. climate change education
 - 5.1 mitigation
 - 5.2 adaptation
 - 5.3 impact reduction
 - 5.4 early warning
6. environmental sustainability
 - 6.1 caring for the planet, protecting nature
 - 6.2 environmental justice
 - 6.3 biodiversity, water
7. human survival and well-being
 - 7.1 environmental health as it pertains to human well-being, disaster risk reduction
 - 7.2 health of the planet for future generations
 - 7.3 sustainable cities and communities
8. sustainable consumption and production
 - 8.1 responsible and sustainable lifestyles
 - 8.2 green economy, green jobs
 - 8.3 sustainable energy

III. Definitions of key terms

Term	Definition
Themes of global citizenship and education for sustainable development	
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	<i>Education about and for diversity including language, ethnicity, race, religion as well as the development of tolerance, mutual respect and appreciation for cultural diversity. It includes intercultural and interreligious dialogue, understanding, solidarity and co-operation, and citizenship education.</i>
2. Gender equality education	<i>Education that addresses the wider issue of gender equality by promoting new attitudes and patterns of belief, transforming the way people think about traditional gender roles and helping to build long-term sustainable change. It examines how gender roles, activities, needs, opportunities, rights and entitlements affect men, women, girls and boys differently. It deals with the relationships between females and males, their access to and control of resources and the constraints they face relative to each other. It respects the rights of all learners – women, men, boys and girls – equally and gives equal access to learning opportunities, resources and protections. All learners benefit from and are treated in education equally without the limitations set by stereotypes, rigid gender roles and prejudices. It covers gender-based equal opportunities, gender equality and justice, and gender roles, identity and stereotypes.</i>
3. Human rights education	<i>Education that promotes universal respect for and observance of all human rights and fundamental freedoms and thus contributes, inter alia, to the prevention of human rights violations and abuses by providing persons with knowledge, skills and understanding and developing their attitudes and behaviours, to empower them to contribute to the building and promotion of a universal culture of human rights.</i> <i>It includes equality and non-discrimination, human rights values, dignity, justice, inclusion and participation and respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms.</i>
4. Peace and non-violence	<i>Education about peace and peace-building, mediation, conflict prevention and resolution, non-violence, reconciliation and living together peacefully. It includes advocating for friendly relations among peoples and nations, challenging negative stereotypes, promoting peaceful solutions, learning to live together and preventing violent extremism and other forms of violence including bullying.</i>
5. Climate change education	<i>Education to help people, in particular youth, understand, address, mitigate, and adapt to the impacts of climate change. It encourages changes in attitudes and behaviours needed to put the world on a more sustainable development path, and build a new generation of climate change-aware citizens.</i> <i>It covers various responses to climate change including mitigation, adaptation, impact reduction and early warning.</i>
6. Environmental sustainability	<i>Education about responsible interactions with the environment to avoid depletion or degradation and to promote environmental quality and health. It includes, caring for the planet and protecting nature, environmental justice, biodiversity and water.</i>
7. Human survival and well-being	<i>Education that promotes social well-being and harmony including in future generations due to healthy environmental systems. It includes health of the planet and environment related to human well-being, disaster risk reduction and sustainable cities and communities.</i>

8. Sustainable consumption and production	<i>Education on the use and production of resources, products and services that have a minimal adverse impact on the environment. It promotes resource and energy efficiency, sustainable infrastructure and green jobs. It includes responsible and sustainable lifestyles, the green economy and sustainable energy.</i>
Dimensions of learning	
Knowledge	<i>Factual information and understanding acquired through study and/or experience.</i>
Skills	<i>The ability to carry out a task well as a result of training, practice and innate aptitude. Skills may be physical, mental or both.</i>
Values	<i>Principles that form the foundation on which individuals conduct themselves and interact with others and with the environment around them.</i>
Attitudes and behaviours	<i>Ability to act on the basis of beliefs and knowledge acquired through study or experience.</i>
Levels of education	
Pre-primary	<i>Education designed to support children's early cognitive, physical, social and emotional development and introduce young children to organized instruction outside of the family context. Participants are usually aged from three years.</i>
Primary and secondary	<i>Education designed to:</i> <i>(i) provide students with fundamental skills in reading, writing and mathematics (i.e. literacy and numeracy) and establish a solid foundation for learning and understanding core areas of knowledge and personal development (primary education); and</i> <i>(ii) prepare students for further education at post-secondary and tertiary levels and for entry into the labour market (secondary education).</i> <i>It includes both general and vocational education.</i>
Tertiary	<i>Education designed to provide learning activities in specialised fields of education. It aims at learning at a high level of complexity and specialisation. It includes both what is commonly understood as academic education and advanced vocational or professional education.</i>
Types of education	
Adult education	<i>Education specifically targeted at individuals who are regarded as adults by their society to improve their technical or professional qualifications, further develop their abilities, enrich their knowledge with the purpose to complete a level of formal education, or to acquire, refresh or update their knowledge, skills and competencies in a particular field.</i>
Formal education	<i>Education that is institutionalized, intentional and planned through public organizations and recognized private bodies which – in their totality – constitute the formal education system of a country. Formal education programmes are recognized by the relevant national or sub-national education authorities. Formal education consists mostly of initial education (e.g., pre-primary, primary, secondary and tertiary education).</i>
Non-formal education	<i>Education that is an addition, alternative and/or a complement to formal education within the process of the lifelong learning of individuals. It is often provided to guarantee the right of access to education for all. It caters to people of all ages but does not necessarily apply a continuous pathway-structure. It may be short in duration and/or low-intensity, and it is typically provided in the form of short courses, workshops or seminars. Non-formal education mostly leads to qualifications that are not</i>

	<i>recognized by the relevant national or sub-national education authorities or to no qualifications at all. Non-formal education includes programmes on life skills including literacy and numeracy, work skills, and social or cultural development. Most types of adult education are also included.</i>
Vocational education	<i>Education that is designed for learners to acquire the knowledge, skills and competencies specific to a particular occupation or trade or class of occupations or trades. Vocational education may have work-based components (e.g. apprenticeships). Successful completion of such programmes leads to labour-market relevant vocational qualifications acknowledged as occupationally-oriented by the relevant national authorities and/or the labour market. Vocational education can be offered at secondary and post-secondary or tertiary levels of education.</i>

IV. Information about the respondent

Country:

Armenia

Organization:

Ministry of Education, Science, Culture and Sport

Date of submission:

28.12.2020

V. Other contributors consulted during the completion of this questionnaire

Please indicate below the names of other organizations and contributors consulted during the completion of this questionnaire.

Government institutions including other Ministries (please specify):

Ministry of Environment

National human rights institutions (please specify):

Office of the Human Rights Defender

Local and regional authorities responsible for education (please specify):

Other local and regional authorities (please specify):

Organizations representing education stakeholders (e.g. teachers, students, parents, etc.) (please specify):

UNICEF, Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ), American University of Armenia's Acopian Center for the Environment, "Poqrik Ishkhan" School – Educational Complex, EcoLab, Yerevan High School # 97, Yerevan Basic School # 122

Other civil society organizations (please specify):

Armenian Tree Project, Association for Sustainable Human Development

Others (please specify):

VI. Questionnaire

A. Laws and policies (preamble and paras 4 and 7 of the 1974 Recommendation)

A1a. Please describe any specific national or sub-national laws, legislation or legal framework(s) in your country that govern the promotion of global citizenship education (GCED) and/or education for sustainable development (ESD). Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes² are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

- The state standard of general education of the Republic of Armenia is being revised, which is based on the capacities. Curricula are developed on the basis of the standard, which also includes all the principles of the formation of a democratic culture.
- The Ministry of Education, Science, Culture and Sports of Armenia cooperates with the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of RA within the framework of UNESCO educational programs, as well as within the framework of organizing the work of the network of UNESCO Associated Schools of the Republic of Armenia.
- Changes are being made to the current teacher training system, which will allow trainings to be organized by the organizations selected as a result of the competition, as well as through existing online courses, including foreign languages, which will be guaranteed by the Ministry. The relevant requirements set out in point 7 of Part A of the questionnaire are included in a separate section in the teacher training.
- The main public policy framework is defined by the Armenia Development Strategy 2014-2025 approved by Government Decision № 442, 27th March 2014. The ADS identifies four priorities:
 1. Growth of Employment;
 2. Development of human capital;
 3. Improvement of the social protection system; and
 4. Institutional modernisation of the public administration and governance systems.

The focus of Priority 2 is to improve access to middle vocational and higher education, enhance the quality of professional education and align it with the needs of the labour market. The primary goal is to promote the employment of graduates.

- The main legal act regulating education, particularly VET, is the “Law on Education” adopted in 1999. It establishes the principles of the state policy in the field of education, the state guarantees for the right to education, the legal and organisational as well as financial and economic grounds of the education system. The Law defines the structure of the education system, the main concepts related to it the levels and types of education and other principal aspects.
- The “Law on Preliminary Vocational (Craftsmanship) and Middle Vocational Education”, was adopted in 2005 after endorsement of the VET Strategy in 2004. This law defines more specific issues related to VET and serves as a base for an extensive number of by-law regulating different aspects of VET.
- There are number of other laws which relate to several aspects of VET. Thus, e.g. the “Law on State Non-commercial Organisations” regulates many administrative and management issues of the VET institutions; the Law on Licensing defines the rules and procedures of VET provision

² See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

licensing, the Law On Social Protection of Children Left without Parental Care establishes privileges for those children for enjoying vocational and higher education, etc.

- In August 2019, the MoESCS approved the Plan for Implementing the 2017-2023 Measures in the Field of VET by the Order № 590-A/2, 30th August 2019. The Plan includes 9 policy priorities:

- ☐ Structural Reforms;
- ☐ Strengthening the Social Partnership;
- ☐ Updating the content of educational programs;
- ☐ Development of models for organising educational process;
- ☐ Improving assessment forms;
- ☐ Introduction of Internet-based educational technologies;
- ☐ Internationalisation of the VET system;
- ☐ Promoting youth employment and entrepreneurship;
- ☐ Human Resource Development Strategy.

- “National Strategy on Development of Ecological Education and Upbringing” was developed by the Ministry of Environment and approved by the Government /22.02.2018 N7/ of Republic of Armenia. The main goal of the strategy is the Improvement of the environmental education system in the Republic of Armenia, the expansion of harmonious and mutually beneficial cooperation between the state, society, and international organizations in this area, promoting environmental awareness of society and responsible attitude to the environment. Main strategic directions are as follows;

- ☐ Improvement of legislation;
- ☐ Ensuring the harmonious development of environmental and educational policy in the field of general education;
- ☐ Supplementing the area of primary (vocational), secondary, higher, and postgraduate education with thematic courses based on the principles of sustainable development;
- ☐ Improvement of the policy of raising the level of public awareness on environmental issues;
- ☐ Using the opportunities for non-formal and informal education to raise public awareness and Pro-environmental behavior.

- The Disaster Risk Management National Strategy and the Action Plan (approved by the Government on April 6, 2017, N14 Decree) - The strategy aims to establish a disaster-resilient country, reduce disaster risk and loss of human lives, livelihood, and health, as well as economic, physical, social, cultural and environmental losses of people, organizations, communities and the country to ensure increased safety of individuals and the society and the sustainable development of the country.

- Revision of the “Law on Ecological Education and Upbringing of the Population” (November 17, 2017) - This law regulates the principles of state policy, legal, organizational, financial and economic bases in the field of continuous ecological education of the population.

A1b. Please provide the full names of any laws, legislation or legal frameworks referred to in A1a and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

- “Law on Education” adopted in 1999,
<https://www.arlis.am/documentview.aspx?docID=68299>
- “Law on Preschool Education” adopted in 2005,
<https://www.arlis.am/DocumentView.aspx?docid=21490>
- “Law on General Education” adopted in 2009,
<https://www.arlis.am/documentview.aspx?docid=94718>
- “Law on Preliminary Vocational (Craftsmanship) and Middle Vocational Education”, adopted in 2005 after endorsement of the VET Strategy in 2004,
<https://www.arlis.am/documentview.aspx?docid=90706>
- “Law on Higher and postgraduate professional education” adopted in 2004,
<https://www.arlis.am/documentview.aspx?docid=25820>
- “Law on State Non-commercial Organisations”
- “Law on Licensing” defines the rules and procedures of Preschool, General, VET and Higher education provision licensing <https://www.arlis.am/documentview.aspx?docid=64631c>
- “Law On Social Protection of Children Left without Parental Care” establishes privileges for those children for enjoying vocational and higher education, etc
- “Law on Ecological Education and Upbringing of the Population” (November 17, 2017)
<https://www.arlis.am/DocumentView.aspx?docid=1006>
- The state standard of general education of the Republic of Armenia (amended)
- Teacher training procedure
- Procedure for selecting training organizations
- Armenia Development Strategy 2014-2025 approved by Government Decision № 442, 27th March 2014,
https://policy.thinkbluedata.com/sites/default/files/Development%20Strategy%20of%20the%20Republic%20of%20Armenia%20for%202014-2025_ENG.pdf
- The Plan for Implementing the 2017-2023 Measures in the Field of VET by the Order № 590-A/2, 30th August 2019
- "On approving National Strategy on development of Ecological Education and Upbringing" Protocol Decree No 7, 22 February 2018 Government of the Republic of Armenia <https://www.e-gov.am/protocols/item/873/>
- Disaster Risk Management National Strategy and Implementation Action Plan (approved by the Government on April 6, 2017, N14 decree <http://www.irtek.am/views/act.aspx?aid=89604>

*A2 Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are covered in national or sub-national laws, legislation or legal frameworks on education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown, 99 = not applicable (e.g. where the given level of government is not responsible for education)

	National				Sub-national			
	Pre-primary	Primary/secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal	Pre-primary	Primary/secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	9	1	1	1	9
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	9	1	1	1	9
3. Human rights	1	1	1	9	1	1	1	9
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	9	1	1	1	9
5. Climate change	0	1	99	1	0	1	99	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1	1	1	99	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	99	1	1	1	99	1

A3a. Please describe any specific current national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives in your country that promote global citizenship education (GCED) and/or education for sustainable development (ESD). Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes³ are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

- The State Standard of General Education of the Republic of Armenia is based on competencies, which correspond to the principles of GCED (global citizenship education) & ESD (education for sustainable development). They are designed for three levels of education (elementary, middle, high), taking into account the age characteristics of the students.
- The MoESCS of RA approved the Plan for Implementing the 2017-2023 Measures in the Field of VET by the Order № 590-A/2, 30th August 2019 . The Plan includes 9 policy priorities:
 - ☐ Structural Reforms;
 - ☐ Strengthening the Social Partnership;
 - ☐ Updating the content of educational programs;
 - ☐ Development of models for organising educational process, including work-based and dual models;
 - ☐ Improving assessment forms;
 - ☐ Introduction of Internet-based educational technologies;
 - ☐ Internationalisation of the VET system;
 - ☐ Promoting youth employment and entrepreneurship;
 - ☐ Human Resource Development Strategy.

³ See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

These priorities are reinforced by a total of 25 measures. All measures are accompanied by expected outputs and outcomes and the sources of verification are defined. Thus, there is a clear guide for action targeted to VET reforms and development.

In the interim, the Ministry is continuing to pursue the priorities defined in the previous strategic documents as well as in the Government Programs for 2017-2022, 2018-2022, 2019-2022. The latter set the following aims for VET:

- ☐ with a view to enhancing the quality of preliminary and middle vocational education and ensuring the match with the Armenian labour market demands, to upgrade agriculture VET particularly via developing and introducing state educational (qualification) standards and relevant curricula in VET with mandatory module on entrepreneurship, by the end of 2019;
 - ☐ with a view to bringing the fields of study in preliminary and middle vocational education institutions in line with the development areas of the marzes of Armenia and the needs of the labour market, to:
 - 1) establish career guidance units with appropriate specialists at VET institutions, by the end of 2017;
 - 2) during 2017-2018, study the priority sectors of the economy, the future development trends, as well as the ratio of the labour market demand and supply;
 - ☐ in order to consolidate preliminary vocational education institutions, improve the management and cost-efficiency of VET institutions, to optimise (consolidate) the VET institutions during 2017-2020.
- Within the framework of the “Law on Higher and postgraduate professional education” there is a provision, which defines that the Armenian higher education institutions have the competency in organizing the admission, as well academic process, for foreign citizens from all over the world. The higher education institutions, on the basis of agreements signed with relevant authorized bodies for education of foreign States, carry out admission of foreign citizens, preparation and training of specialists.
 - National Strategy for Development of Ecological Education and Upbringing (February 22, 2018, Government Decree N7) - the main goal of the strategy is the Improvement of the environmental education system in the Republic of Armenia, the expansion of harmonious and mutually beneficial cooperation between the state, society, and international organizations in this area, promoting environmental awareness of society and responsible attitude to the environment.
 - Exemplary Curriculum (Teaching Plan) of 2020-2021 School Year For General Educational Institutions Implementing General, Specialized And Special State Programs (August 31, 2020) - The Curriculum of the educational institution defines the structure of the content of secondary education, the weekly hours allocated to general education subjects according to the components.

A3b. Please provide the full names of any education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives referred to in A3a and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

1. Draft State Standard and Subject Standards of General Education.
(<https://escs.am/am/search?q=%D5%B9%D5%A1%D6%83%D5%B8%D6%80%D5%B8%D5%B7%D5%AB%D5%B9>)
2. Armenia Development Strategy 2014-2025 (Government Decision № 442, 27th March 2014) - https://eeas.europa.eu/sites/eeas/files/armenia_development_strategy_for_2014-2025.pdf
3. RA Government Program for 2017-2022; <http://www.gov.am/files/docs/2207.pdf>

4. RA Government Program for 2018-2022; <http://www.gov.am/files/docs/2920.pdf>
5. RA Government Program for 2019-2023; <https://www.gov.am/files/docs/3347.pdf>
6. VET Strategic Program for 2018-2022 and Action Plan for its Implementation (will be attached to the template)
7. "On approving National Strategy on Development of Ecological Education and Upbringing" Protocol Decree No 7, 22 February 2018 Government of the Republic of Armenia ; <https://www.e-gov.am/protocols/item/873/>
8. Exemplary Curriculum (Teaching Plan) of 2020-2021 School Year For General Educational Institutions Implementing General, Specialized And Special State Programs (August 31, 2020) - <https://www.arlis.am/DocumentView.aspx?docID=145701>

*A4. Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are covered in national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives affecting each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	0	9
2. Gender equality	1	1	9	9
3. Human rights	1	1	1	9
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	0	9
5. Climate change	0	1	0	9
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	0	9
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	0	9

*A5 Please indicate whether national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives on education provide a mandate to integrate GCED and ESD in the following areas by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown, 99 = not applicable (e.g. where the given level of government is not responsible for education)

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
National				
Design or revision of the curricula	1	1	1	1
Setting of programme learning objectives	1	1	1	1
Textbook development	1	1	1	1
Teacher education and training	1	1	1	1
Assessment of student outcomes	1	1	1	1
Sub-national				
Design or revision of the curricula	1	1	1	99
Setting of programme learning objectives	1	1	1	99
Textbook development	1	1	1	99
Teacher education and training	1	1	1	99
Assessment of student outcomes	1	1	1	99

B. Curriculum (paras 4 and 10-19 of the 1974 Recommendation)

B1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are mainstreamed in school curricula. Indicate whether topics are taught as standalone subjects or are integrated into the curricula of other subjects. Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes⁴ are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

In the system of general education- New subject programs are developed in such a way that general subject "cross-concepts" for all subjects are included in the curricula of different subjects, so that these concepts are introduced during the teaching of specific subjects, and if necessary, presented in the same way. Among the intersecting concepts are the provisions GCED and ESD. For example, environmental topics are studied extensively in biology and geography, but at the same time, physics, chemistry, history, and other subjects are studied (for example, the end result of the physics curriculum emphasizes the economical use of natural resources) from the point of view of environmental problems). Me and My Surrounding subject is taught 2-4 grade level students. Preliminary Military Preparation and Safe Behavior Discipline is also included in the National Curriculum and taught from 8 to 12 upper secondary and high school students.

The following elective subjects approved by the Ministry of Education, Science, Culture and Sports are offered schools to include into their School Curriculum upon their decision: Energy Efficiency, Fundamentals of Ecology and Sustainable Development, Life Skills and Healthy Lifestyle. National Educational and Developmental Standards for Children from Birth to 6 Years

⁴ See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

Old – (Approved by the Ministry of Education and Science in 2011 and reviewed in 2018) - preschool education.

In the VET system the educational standards and the relevant modular programs and curricula for professions and qualifications has been developed and revised and it is the continuing process. Modular programs consist of below-mentioned modular and subject sections, and each of the sections includes the modules and subjects, and the topics referred to GCED and ESD are taught and covered by below mentioned modules and subjects: General humanitarian, Socio-economical, General natural sciences section: Basics of the Armenian language and speech culture, Basics of economics, Basics of political and sociological science, Basics of Law, History, Foreign languages, physical education, Landscape and basics of ecology, Civil Defense and Emergency Issues Key competences: Communication, General competences of work activity, Security and first aid, basic skills on computer operation General professional Special professional

B1b. Please provide examples of curricula in which GCED and/or ESD are mainstreamed and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

The draft state standard for general education has been posted on <https://escs.am/am/news/6718> website.

National Educational and Developmental Standards for Children from Birth to 6 Years Old – (Approved by the Ministry of Education and Science in 2011 and reviewed in 2018) - preschool education: <https://uni.cf/3hhYDtH>

VET educational standards and the relevant modular programs and curricula for professions and qualifications are posted on www.mkuzak.am, http://www.mkuzak.am/?page_id=8282# website.

*B2 Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are taught as part of the curriculum at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	9
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	9
3. Human rights	1	1	1	9
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	9
5. Climate change	0	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

***B3** Please indicate in which subjects or fields of study GCED and ESD are taught in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Cultural diversity and tolerance	Gender equality	Human rights	Peace and non-violence	Climate change	Environmental sustainability	Human survival and well-being	Sustainable consumption and production
Arts	1	0	0	0	1	1	0	0
Civics, civil or citizenship education	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Ethics/moral studies	9	9	9	9	9	9	9	9
Geography	1	0	1	1	1	1	1	1
Health, physical education and sports	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	0
History	1	1	1	1	0	1	1	0
Languages	1	0	0	0	0	1	0	0
Mathematics	0	0	0	0	1	1	0	1
Religious education	0	0	1	1	0	0	1	0
Science	0	0	0	0	1	1	1	1
Social studies	1	1	1	1	0	0	1	1
Integrated studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Other (please specify)								

***B4** Please indicate the approaches used to teach GCED and ESD in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Global citizenship and education for sustainable development
GCED/ESD are taught as separate subject(s)	0
Cross-curriculum approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught in more than one subject but not throughout the curriculum)	1
Integrated approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught throughout the whole curriculum)	1
Whole school approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are integrated in the school ethos, management, governance, curriculum, teacher training, teaching practices, the learning environment and in learning experiences in the community and life outside school)	1

B5 Please indicate which human rights education themes are taught as part of the curriculum at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
3. Human rights education				
3.1 equality and non-discrimination based on race, colour, language, religion, disability, political or other opinion, national or social origin, birth or other status	0	1	1	9
3.2 human rights values, human dignity, justice, inclusion and participation	1	1	1	9
3.3 respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (as outlined in international conventions and declarations)	1	1	1	9

C. Teacher education (including the training of trainers and educators) (paras 4 and 33-37 of the *1974 Recommendation*)

C1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are mainstreamed in initial training and in continuing professional development of teachers, trainers and educators. Indicate whether all teachers, trainers and educators or only some are required to receive training to teach GCED and/or ESD.

Pre-certification teacher training is provided for each teacher every five years under the General Education Act, and ongoing training is on schedule and on demand. During all the trainings, reference is made to the standard, subject programs and the strategies and methods proposed for their implementation. As the standards and programs include GCED and ESD provisions, they are also included in the training program.

There is a well-established VET teacher retraining system, coordinated by NCVETD (see also the Section D.2.6). Every year around 1,000 VET teachers are retrained. Thus, between 2014-2017, in total of approximately 4,147 VET teachers were trained by NCVETD (1,122 in 2014; 1,016 in 2015; 934 in 2016, 975 in 2017, and 477 in 2018, 615 in 2019, 1186 in 2020). In addition, during the same period, 198 College Directors and Deputies, 207 Management Board members, 175 standards development experts, and other staff within the VET system were trained on different topics.

Most of the teachers' trainings are dedicated to the pedagogical issues (methodology) and topics related to the sustainable education, human rights, corruption issues. No formal national teacher training programs are available now due to the closure of the National Institute of Education, but are planned to be mainstreamed into the newly established National Fund for Education Development and Innovation.

C1b. Please provide examples of teacher training policies or curricula in which GCED and/or ESD are mainstreamed and, where possible, web links to relevant documents. If possible, include examples related to initial training and to continuing professional development.

The Order of the Minister of Education, Science, Culture and Sports of RA on the approval of the teacher training standard and exemplary program subject to regular attestation (by the Order № 1162-A/2, 7th September 2020).

Teacher Attestation Program – approved by the Government on October 14, 2010 - <https://www.arlis.am/documentView.aspx?docid=65405>

The required information about the VET system posted on [www.mkuzak.am](http://www.mkuzak.am/?page_id=166) ; http://www.mkuzak.am/?page_id=166 website.

***C2** Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to teach GCED and ESD during initial or pre-service training and/or through continuing professional development. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Initial or pre-service training				
For teachers of selected subjects only (in which GCED or ESD are typically taught)	0	1	1	1
For teachers of other subjects	0	1	9	9
Continuing professional development				
For teachers of selected subjects only (in which GCED or ESD are typically taught)	0	1	1	1
For teachers of other subjects	0	1	9	9

***C3** Please indicate on which GCED and ESD themes pre-service or in-service training is available for teachers, trainers and educators at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	9	9
2. Gender equality	0	1	9	9
3. Human rights	1	1	9	9
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	9	9
5. Climate change	0	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	9

*C4 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to teach the following dimensions of learning in GCED and ESD. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Knowledge	1	1	1	1
Skills	1	1	1	1
Values	1	1	1	1
Attitudes and behaviours	1	1	1	1

*C5 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to use the following approaches to teach GCED and ESD in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Global citizenship and education for sustainable development
GCED/ESD are taught as separate subject(s)	0
Cross curriculum approach (e.g. <i>GCED/ESD are taught in more than one subject but not throughout the curriculum</i>)	1
Integrated approach (e.g. <i>GCED/ESD are taught throughout the whole curriculum</i>)	1
Whole school approach (e.g. <i>GCED/ESD are integrated in the school ethos, management, governance, curriculum, teacher training, teaching practices, the learning environment, and in learning experiences in the community and life outside school</i>)	1

D. Student assessment (paras 4 and 5 of the *1974 Recommendation*)

D1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are covered in student assessments and examinations. Indicate whether students are assessed only on their knowledge of and skills related to the topics being tested or also on their values, attitudes and/or behaviours.

In the system of general education- The current grading system addresses GCED and ESD issues mainly when examining items that are related to GCED and ESD in one way or another.

In the VET system - The state educational standards described in the previous section are composed of modules (units) and for each of them, sets of learning outcomes with corresponding performance criteria, which can be objectively measured, and assessment means are defined.

Those modules are grouped into two clusters: Key skills and Professional Competences. The key skills include the following modules (all for 54 hours) which are common for all qualifications' standards:

- ☐ Communication;
- ☐ Safety and First Aid;
- ☐ General Working Skills;
- ☐ Entrepreneurship;
- ☐ Computer Driving.

In addition, every curricula includes a number of subjects which are mandatory for all VET programs. These subjects and their durations by hours are:

- ☐ Armenian Language and Basics of Speech Culture – 72;
- ☐ Basics of Economics – 54;
- ☐ Basics of Political Science and Sociology – 54;
- ☐ Basics of Law – 36;
- ☐ History – 54;
- ☐ Russian language – 72;
- ☐ Second Foreign language – 72;
- ☐ Physical education – 130;
- ☐ Landscape Studies and Basics of Ecology – 36;
- ☐ Civil Defence and Basics of Emergency Situations – 28.

Depending on the qualification, some of those subjects may be removed as instead the students are taught corresponding professional modules. E.g. for all economic qualifications, such as “Accountant”, the subject “Basics of Economics” is not foreseen and the curricula includes an extensive number of economics-related modules. For the qualification “Legist”, the subject “Basics of Law” is out of the curricula.

The curricula for secondary VET (instruction on the base on basic general education), includes also a number of general subjects, such as mathematics, physics, chemistry, geography, etc. This ensures acquisition, along with the vocational qualification, of secondary general education which allows the VET graduates to continue their education in universities.

Based on the “Law on Higher and postgraduate education” of RA, state ensures the development of higher education by the way of introducing new forms of knowledge testing and producing the methods for assessment, including introduction of credit systems within the system of higher education. State educational standard for higher education includes all the requirements concerning the mandatory minimum of the content of the study programs, as well, the conditions for the implementation there of, including the assessment of the process and final attestation of graduates. Taking into the consideration

the autonomy and academic freedom of higher education institutions, the institutions act independently in the academic process and independently determine the forms of assessment.

***D2** Please indicate whether the GCED and ESD themes below are generally included in student assessments or examinations at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	0	1	9	9
2. Gender equality	0	1	9	9
3. Human rights	0	1	9	9
4. Peace and non-violence	0	1	9	9
5. Climate change	0	1	9	1
6. Environmental sustainability	0	1	9	1
7. Human survival and well-being	0	1	9	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	0	1	9	1

***D3** Please indicate which of the dimensions of learning in GCED and ESD below are generally included in student assessments or examinations at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Knowledge	1	1	1	1
Skills	1	1	1	1
Values	0	1	1	1
Attitudes and behaviours	0	1	1	1

E. Mainstreaming of GCED and ESD in laws and policies, curricula, teacher education and student assessment (paras 4-5, 7, 10-19 and 33-37 of the 1974 Recommendation)

*E1 Based on your responses to questions in the previous four sections (laws and policies, curricula, teacher education and student assessment) please indicate to what extent global citizenship education (GCED) and education for sustainable development (ESD) are mainstreamed⁵ in (a) education laws and policies, (b) curricula (c) teacher education (including the training of trainers and educators) and (d) student assessment in your country. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell in the table below.

KEY:

0 Not at all

GCED and ESD are not mainstreamed.

1 Partially

Some GCED and/or ESD themes⁶ are mainstreamed. Select this option if GCED is mainstreamed but ESD is not (or vice versa).

2 Extensively

Most GCED and ESD themes are mainstreamed.

9 Not known

It is not known whether GCED and ESD are mainstreamed or not.

99 Not applicable

The given level of government does not have responsibility for the given component (policies, curricula, teacher education or student assessment) and/or does not have responsibility for the given level or type of education. This may occur at the national level in federal countries where education is the responsibility of individual states or at the sub-national level in small countries where there is only one level of government.

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
National				
(a) Education laws and policies	1	1	0	2
(b) Curricula	1	1	2	1
(c) Teacher education	1	1	2	1
(d) Student assessment	0	1	2	1
Sub-national				
(a) Education laws and policies	1	1	2	99
(b) Curricula	1	1	2	99
(c) Teacher education	1	1	2	99
(d) Student assessment	0	1	2	99

⁵ GCED and ESD are mainstreamed if their themes are mentioned explicitly in relevant documents and are expected to be implemented by the relevant authorities (e.g. Ministries, regional or local education authorities), educational institutions (e.g. schools, colleges and universities) and/or education professionals (e.g. teachers, lecturers, trainers and educators) as appropriate.

⁶ Refer to the schema in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

F. Technical and vocational education and training (paras 25-29 of the 1974 Recommendation)

F1 Please describe any major initiatives that have been undertaken to promote GCED and/or ESD in technical and vocational education and training. Describe briefly the outcomes and impact of such initiatives and provide examples of good practices.

• The main public policy framework is defined by the Armenia Development Strategy 2014-2025 approved by Government Decision № 442, 27th March 2014. The ADS identifies four priorities:

1. Growth of Employment;
2. Development of human capital;
3. Improvement of the social protection system; and
4. Institutional modernisation of the public administration and governance systems.

The focus of Priority 2 is to improve access to middle vocational and higher education, enhance the quality of professional education and align it with the needs of the labour market. The primary goal is to promote the employment of graduates.

• The main legal act regulating education, particularly VET, is the “Law on Education” adopted in 1999. It establishes the principles of the state policy in the field of education, the state guarantees for the right to education, the legal and organizational as well as financial and economic grounds of the education system. The Law defines the structure of the education system, the main concepts related to it the levels and types of education and other principal aspects.

• The “Law on Preliminary Vocational (Craftsmanship) and Middle Vocational Education”, was adopted in 2005 after endorsement of the VET Strategy in 2004. This law defines more specific issues related to VET and serves as a base for an extensive number of by-law regulating different aspects of VET.

• There are number of other laws which relate to several aspects of VET. Thus, e.g. the “Law on State Non-commercial Organisations” regulates the many administrative and management issues of the VET institutions; the Law on Licensing defines the rules and procedures of VET provision licensing, the “Law On Social Protection of Children Left without Parental Care” establishes privileges for those children for enjoying vocational and higher education, etc.

• In August 2019, the MoESCS approved the Plan for Implementing the 2017-2023 Measures in the Field of VET by the Order № 590-A/2, 30th August 2019. The Plan includes 9 policy priorities:

- ☐ Structural Reforms;
- ☐ Strengthening the Social Partnership;
- ☐ Updating the content of educational programs;
- ☐ Development of models for organising educational process;
- ☐ Improving assessment forms;
- ☐ Introduction of Internet-based educational technologies;
- ☐ Internationalisation of the VET system;
- ☐ Promoting youth employment and entrepreneurship;
- ☐ Human Resource Development Strategy.

- There is a well-established VET teacher retraining system, coordinated by NCVETD (see also the Section D.2.6). Every year around 1,000 VET teachers are retrained. Thus, between 2014-2017, in total of approximately 4,147 VET teachers were trained by NCVETD (1,122 in 2014; 1,016 in 2015; 934 in 2016, 975 in 2017, and 477 in 2018, 615 in 2019, 1186 in 2020). In addition, during the same period, 198 College Directors and Deputies, 207 Management Board members, 175 standards development experts, and other staff within the VET system were trained on different topics. Most of the teachers' trainings are dedicated to the pedagogical issues (methodology) and topics related to the sustainable education, human rights, corruption issues.

- The state educational standards described in the previous section, are composed of modules (units) and for each of them, sets of learning outcomes with corresponding performance criteria, which can be objectively measured, and assessment means are defined. Those modules are grouped into two clusters: Key skills and Professional Competences. The key skills include the following modules (all for 54 hours) which are common for all qualifications' standards:

- ☐ Communication;
- ☐ Safety and First Aid;
- ☐ General Working Skills;
- ☐ Entrepreneurship;
- ☐ Computer Driving.

In addition, every curricula includes a number of subjects which are mandatory for all VET programs. These subjects and their durations by hours are:

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- ☐ Basics of Economics – 54;
- ☐ Basics of Political Science and Sociology – 54;
- ☐ Basics of Law – 36;
- ☐ History – 54;
- ☐ Russian language – 72;
- ☐ Second Foreign language – 72;
- ☐ Physical education – 130;
- ☐ Landscape Studies and Basics of Ecology – 36;
- ☐ Civil Defence and Basics of Emergency Situations – 28.

Depending on the qualification, some of those subjects may be removed as instead the students are taught corresponding professional modules. E.g. for all economic qualifications, such as "Accountant", the subject "Basics of Economics" is not foreseen and the curricula includes an extensive number of economics-related modules. For the qualification "Legist", the subject "Basics of Law" is out of the curricula.

The curricula for secondary VET (instruction on the base on basic general education), includes also a number of general subjects, such as mathematics, physics, chemistry, geography, etc. This provides the acquisition, along with the vocational qualification, of secondary general education which allows the VET graduates to continue their education in universities.

During 2018-2019, the following has been achieved:

- ☐ With the aim of improving the efficiency of the VET institutions' Governing Boards and for ensuring the full implementation of their functions, in 2018 revised Social

Partnership Concept was agreed with the VET National Council and approved by the order of Minister of Education and Science.

□ For matching the preliminary (craftsmanship) and middle vocational professions and qualifications with labour market realities and directions of economic development of RA regions, the Classifier of VET professions and qualifications was revised by the Government.

□ In 2018-2019, 1079 people working in the VET system (College Directors, Deputies, teachers, and other specialists) were trained with the support of NCVETD.

□ The monthly journal "Vocational Education and Training" is being published. □ To modernize VET content and meet the labour market needs, in 2018-2019, 48 VET state educational standards were developed and revised, and approved. The all include a compulsory module of Entrepreneurship.

□ Highlighting the importance of career guidance services, as well as the expansion and development of cooperation between educational institutions and employers career guidance centers exist in all VET institutions of the RA. By 2019 State Budget a staffing unit is set up for a specialist of professional orientation and career guidance in 95 VET institutions. The process of continuous training and consulting of career executives is regularly carried out. Career Consultants have commenced providing career guidance services to students, graduates as well as VET applicants.

□ Within the "Skills Connexion" ETF regional project, the draft Concept of Work-based Learning was developed. In the framework of the project the national working group on WBL has been set up. The Group has developed "Concept paper and road map of WBL development in Armenia for 2019-2025", which was approved in the session of National Council for VET Development held on 25th of June, 2019. Pilot training on work-based learning of agricultural professions 'Milk and Dairy Technology' and 'Veterinary' is organized in Stepanavan, Gavar and Goris State Agricultural Colleges from September of 2019.

□ In order to optimise the network of preliminary (craftsmanship) and middle vocational education institutions, improve effectiveness of management and increase cost efficiency of VET institutions, a mapping of above institutions was done by MoESCS.

□ The next phase of the 2018-2020 Torino Process has started. The Torino Process 2018-2020 National Report of Armenia has been developed.

□ In August 2019, the MoESCS approved the Plan for Implementing the 2017-2023 Measures in the Field of VET by the Order № 590-A/2, 30th August 2019.

□ To raise the quality and attractiveness of vocational education and training, and in particular its responsiveness to labor market needs the Ministry of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia in cooperation with GIZ in the framework of "Private Sector Development and Vocational Education and Training in the South Caucasus" project during 2017-2019 has started the introduction of a dual system in VET institutions. In 2018-2019, 8 curricula of the selected professions on the experimental dual system have been developed and approved by the order of the Minister of Education and Science of the Republic of Armenia, which have been introduced in selected 6 VET institutions from September. Five long-term dual education courses and three short-term training programs are currently being taught in 10 VET schools and

about 45 cooperation memorandums have been signed between educational institutions and employers. Based on monitoring results, it is envisaged to expand the model implementation process gradually.

□ Educational institutions periodically review the professions taught at their educational institutions to match VET professions and skills provided by their institutions to the demand of labour market according to the priority sectors of economy and regional development programs. In order to adjust the list of professions of the Preliminary (Craftsmanship) and Middle Vocational Education to the development directions of the regions and the professions of the labor market, the lists of professions of Preliminary (Craftsmanship) and Middle Vocational Education were reviewed and changes were made in them in 2018. As a result of the review 3 professions and 8 qualifications were removed from the lists of professions and 3 new professions and 1 qualification were included in the lists: In 2019 due to the labor market demand new professions are introduced in VET educational institutions from September 2019, particularly,

□ "Dry Construction" profession is introduced at the College of State University of Architecture and Construction"

□ "Technology of Tobacco Growing and Processing" profession with "Technologist of Tobacco Cultivation and Processing" qualification is introduced in Masis State Agricultural College.

□ "Refrigeration System" is introduced in Yerevan State Regional College N2 Named after N. Atchemyan, Ararat and Armavir Regional State Colleges. The admission of the 2019/2020 academic year was also carried out in the field of new professions in the above mentioned educational institutions. All admission places are filled.

□ Laboratories, equipment and tractors were provided to a number of VET institutions, manuals, short-term programs have been developed by donor organizations actively involved in the reform process of Preliminary and Middle Vocational Education. The Torino Process implemented under the auspices of the European Training Foundation (ETF). Reports for 2012, 2014, 2016 and 2018-2020 (AnnexA0.13) have been developed with direct involvement of MoESCS, NCVETD and other relevant structures. The findings are strongly considered while developing VET policy and strategy papers and also for critical analysis of the ongoing VET reforms. Available at the following links: http://www.etf.europa.eu/web.nsf/pages/TRP_2012_Armenia ; http://www.etf.europa.eu/web.nsf/pages/TRP_2014_Armenia ; http://www.etf.europa.eu/web.nsf/pages/TRP_2016-17_Armenia

G. Adult education (para 30 of the 1974 Recommendation)

G1 Please describe any major initiatives that have been undertaken to promote GCED and/or ESD in adult education and other forms of non-formal education including youth education, out-of-school education, etc. Describe briefly the outcomes and impact of such initiatives and provide examples of good practices.

- Within the framework of UNDP project “Generate global environmental benefits through environmental education and raising awareness of stakeholders/2015-2019/” with collaboration with the American University of Armenia E-learning course comprised of comprehensive 11 training modules focusing on environmental protection and natural resource management developed.
- 240 teachers of public schools and lecturers were trained to deliver EE programs.
- 1500 decision-makers (civil and community servants, leaders of local communities, members of councils of the elders, the staff of local self-governing bodies, private sector) trained on sustainable management of natural resources.
- Capacity built for 34 CBOs to use environmental education and awareness raising as tools for sustainable natural resource management.
- 72 journalists representing 23 media outlets, as well as professors from different universities engaged in journalism teaching were trained on environmental awareness including global environmental issues and solutions.
- “Environmental Journalism” manual was developed and “Environmental Journalism” was introduced in the curricula of Yerevan State University of Languages and Social Sciences.
- One public awareness campaign related to the implementation of three Rio Conventions and Aarhus convention in Armenia was completed.
- 12 Radio Programs related to environmental protection with a special focus on the sectoral legal framework were developed and broadcasted by Public Radio of Armenia.
- “Eco-platform” TV project was developed. Totally of 16 TV programs were filmed and broadcasted by the Public Television of Armenia (<https://www.1tv.am/hy/program/videos/Etnhwnpawly>).
- 8 billboards on pro-environmental public awareness were developed.
- 20 Data Stories on different environmental topics related to the implementation of Rio Conventions in Armenia were developed. The special section on the environment was created in on-line media platform Ampop.am (<https://ampop.am/category/ecology/>).
- 4 short animations on implementation of Rio Conventions and Aarhus convention in Armenia were developed. Source: <https://www.am.undp.org/content/armenia/en/home/projects/environmental-education.html>
- Environmental Education Network (EEN) was established in Armenia in 2014 which aims at contributing to the efforts of RA Government in promoting and ensuring environmental education at all school levels and communities. The EEN is a unity of more than fifteen civil society, governmental, educational and international organizations, the main goal of which is to

endorse the efforts of Armenia in promoting and ensuring environmental education at all school levels and communities. With the Memorandum of Understanding signed by all of the EEN members, Armenia undertakes an action of improving the environmental education, with the help of additional exchange of knowledge and experience. Source :

<https://ace.aua.am/environmental-education/een/>

- “Adolescents for Climate Action in Their Communities” (2019-2022), funded by the Austrian Development Agency (ADA) with funds of Austrian Development Cooperation, and implemented by UNICEF in partnership with Ministries of Environment, Territorial Administration and Infrastructure, Education, Science, Culture and Sport. The project will be coordinated with consolidated communities, regional administrations, schools and teachers, and, more importantly, adolescents. Adolescent aims to support girls and boys and communities take action on climate change mitigation, adaptation, impact reduction and early warning through education, enhanced local governance, human and institutional capacity development. The Project is implemented in 52 consolidated communities covering 47 settlements and 494 schools and reaching over 30.000 school students and 1500 teachers.

- ☐ International Youth Day, World – August 12, 2020
- ☐ Environment Day, June 5, 2020
- ☐ Forest Summit, Global Action and Armenia, 2019
- ☐ World clean-Up day, September 15, 2019.

Source: <https://www.unicef.org/armenia/en/stories/adolescents-climate-action-communities>

- Educational Mandate of the Human Rights Defender One of the key directions of the Human Rights Defender's (HRD) activities is to contribute to changes of human rights system through education and trainings. The Armenian Constitutional Law on the Human Rights Defender stipulates the functions of the Defender to organize trainings for the representatives of the HRD's Office (HRDO), as well as for beneficiary bodies and organizations on issues related to human rights and freedoms (Article 29 of the Constitutional Law). In order to fulfill the above-mentioned mandate, the HRD has established the Human Rights Research and Education Centre within the Human Rights Defender's Office. Among many other duties, the Center is eligible to conduct capacity development trainings for broader groups of stakeholders, such as public servants, civil society, media, students, academia representatives, and more. The Centre also fosters relationships with NGOs within the educational mandate of the HRD. Within its educational mandate, different capacity building seminars and trainings are conducted for the general public, students, public officials and HRDO representatives on human rights of special groups, such as children, women, asylum-seekers, refugees, etc.

- Major initiatives of the HRDO with regard to non-formal education including youth education. To carry out the public education function, the HRD implements a number of initiatives regarding non-formal education including youth education, out-of-school education and carries out awareness-raising activities with an educational component. Below are presented some of the major initiatives in the given field:

- ☐ In the framework of the projects (2017-2019) implemented with the support of the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR) in Armenia (on ensuring the rights of refugees and asylum seekers) a number of trainings have been conducted for the students of different Armenian universities on the rights of refugees and asylum seekers and the HRDO's work in the field. Within the framework of the same projects, the HRD's activities in the field were presented to the Armenian Police and National Security Border Guards Troops, other relevant state bodies and NGOs. For example,

one of the discussions referred primarily to the asylum procedure in Armenia, international defense mechanisms and relevant legislative regulations.

□ In the framework of the projects implemented by the HRDO and funded by the UN OPCAT Special Fund, special trainings for the staff of the Penitentiary Service of Armenia, personnel of penitentiary institutions and mental healthcare organizations were conducted in 2018 and 2019. The trainings organized in 2018 for the Penitentiary Service of Armenia and personnel of penitentiary institutions covered issues concerning the socio-psychological and medical problems in penitentiary institutions, specifically with regard to psychological consultation, organization of health services, medical ethics, prevention of suicide and supervision over hunger strike. In 2019, the training-discussions were initiated for the staff of the Penitentiary Service and penitentiary institutions, including doctors, psychologists and security staff who directly interact with persons deprived of liberty. The trainings were organized for the representatives of the subdivision conducting oversight of the field of psychiatric care and service of the Armenian Ministry of Health, as well as by medical personnel of all psychiatric establishments of Armenia, including regional (doctors, psychotherapists, psychologists, paramedics and nurses), psychiatrists of the Prison Medical Center SNCO of the Armenian Ministry of Justice and other representatives of the medical personnel of the psychiatric ward of the Prison Hospital Penitentiary Institution. The trainings, in general, were aimed at enhancing the professional capacities of the participants on torture, inhuman and degrading treatment prevention, as well as at contributing to the implementation of the HRD's relevant recommendations.

□ In 2020, the HRDO and Kaspersky company organized a seminar on "Adults and Children in the Digital World" for computer science teachers of secondary schools. Computer science teachers from around 100 secondary schools of Yerevan participated in the seminar. During the seminar, issues related to the safety of children in the digital environment and the protection of their rights were discussed. It was particularly emphasized that children are the most vulnerable group in the digital environment and their security, as well as special attention should be given to the protection of their rights.

□ In 2019, with the support of the Konrad Adenauer Foundation, the HRDO organized a number of trainings for mass media representatives, including trainings concerning legal regulations and international standards on freedom of speech and private life. Awareness raising campaign The HRDO also initiates awareness raising campaigns with educational components. One of the successful examples is #changetheworld awareness raising campaign on inclusive education conducted in 2019, which highlighted the principle "no child should be deprived of education or of that opportunity because of health or another issue". Within the campaign, an essay competition on the relevant topic was organized for the Armenian pupils: by a creative work, each child showed by their own example how they could change the world in relation to their friend, making it inclusive and tolerant. More than 700 pupils from the capital and different regions of Armenia participated in the competition.

- Co-operation with different educational establishments The HRDO has well-established co-operation with different educational establishments and has signed a memorandum of understanding (MOUs) with the Faculty of Law of Yerevan State University, Armenian Academy of Justice, Chamber of Advocates of Armenia and Russian-Armenian Slavonic University. The MOUs are aimed at expanding co-operation with the named organizations; each MOU specifies certain directions of co-operation. They envisage the organization and implementation of conferences, seminars, round table discussions, trainings and awareness-raising projects, including for the students of the above-named institutions. Within the framework of the HRD's

co-operation with different educational establishments, the HRDO provides recommendations on the curriculum with regard to human rights.

H. Research and International Co-operation (paras 41-45 of the 1974 *Recommendation*)

H1 Please describe what kinds of research or experimentation have been carried out to improve the implementation of GCED and/or ESD. Describe briefly how the results of such activities have influenced education policies, curricula and/or teaching practices.

- In 2015 GIZ implemented an analysis on Environmental Education in 3 South Caucasus Countries "Environmental Education in 3 South Caucasus schools". Additionally, to draw a broader picture of what the population knows, feels and acts about biodiversity and ecosystem services, in 2016, GIZ carried out nationwide KAP studies for all the three countries of the South Caucasus. The studies were developed as a baseline for developing specific awareness-raising activities. Within the campaign, six teacher manuals were updated and redesigned, which had first been developed by GIZ in 2015. The manuals provide participatory, practice-oriented methods for teaching a variety of environmental topics: Biodiversity in Rural and Urban Environments, Biodiversity of Rivers and Streams of Armenia, Environmental Education in Meadows and Pastures, Environmental Education in Forests and Endangered Species. The manuals were approved for their use in educational institutions by the RA Ministry of Education, Science, Culture and Sports (MoESCS). 300 copies were printed of each manual. 73 teachers from 14 communities in Aragatsotn and Shirak regions were trained as multipliers in the use of the updated teacher manuals.
- In 2018, the German University of Hohenheim (UHOH) and the American University of Armenia's (AUA) Acopian Center for the Environment started collaboration on a 4-year academic exchange program funded by the German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD). The GAtES project studies new approaches for integrating the local perception of ecosystem services with biophysical data (e.g. on biodiversity, erosion processes) and expert-based management plans. One of the approaches tested is the Public Participation GIS (PPGIS), describing the application of GIS technology to support the participation of local people in biodiversity and ES conservation. In the development of the project, IBiS advisors were involved in identifying relevant research topics and proposals. For example, in selected IBiS pilot communities, field research will be conducted on "Pasture management and degradation – Spread of native expanding plants" and "Rural plant collection – wild harvest of food, medicinal and ornamental plants." At present, field studies are partly carried out in pilot communities of the IBiS program.
- As an independent National Human Rights Institution and, as a result of investigation of individual complaints submitted to the HRD, the latter reveals the legislative and systemic human rights issues which are reflected in the HRD's annual and ad hoc reports, providing concrete recommendations for solving the raised issues. The reports are presented to the National Assembly of Armenia and discussed with relevant state authorities aimed at resolving the revealed issues. The named recommendations encompass not only suggestions to make legislative amendments or close legal gaps, but also present examples of good practices to tackle existing practical issues.
 - In the Annual Report on the HRD's activities and state of protection of human rights and freedoms in 2019, the following main issues with regard to the right to education have been raised and discussed:
 - In 2018, the HRD raised the issue of lack of a consistent regulation on fee collection for the use of textbooks in educational institutions, which, as stressed by the

HRD, resulted in discriminatory treatment. The problem was brought before the Constitutional Court, which ultimately concluded that the procedure of providing free textbooks for students from socially insecure families should be precisely provided under the law and by-laws. The issue of fee collection for the use of textbooks in public education institutions remained unresolved as of 2019, which was recorded in the Annual Report.

□ In 2019, issues realizing of the right to education by children with disabilities were raised in the complaints addressed to the HRD. In particular, the issue concerned the absence or scarcity of special textbooks for children with visual (and/or hearing) impairments and children with mental health issues studying at public and special educational institutions. The issue was recorded in 2019 Annual Report, where the HRD noted the necessity of providing an adequate quantity of textbooks, as well as increasing the funding for the printing of textbooks (accessible for persons with disabilities).

□ Although the Armenian Ministry of Education, Science, Culture and Sports, and Yerevan Municipality informed that as a result of the process of the reorganization of the special schools, no child was left without education, in 2019 the HRDO received alarming calls that some children with special needs were excluded from the universal inclusive education. Specifically, according to the parents of the children, the roads leading from their places of residence to the nearest schools and the schools' buildings were not adapted to the special needs of children, as well as there are no special educators in those schools. As a result, the children are confined to home schooling, and are deprived of access to the universal inclusive education.

□ Under Article 24 of the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (the Convention), state parties have a duty to provide persons with disabilities a higher education that is accessible and is with a view to realizing this right without discrimination and on the basis of equal opportunity. In pre-schools, as well as in public educational institutions the accessible environment is mainly limited to the access to ramps and elevators.

□ At the same time, it should be noted that students with disabilities complain that they face many obstacles when exercising their right to higher education. In particular, there is a problem with the educational materials, as well as with physical accessibility. Instructors often assign grades, avoiding conducting examinations and providing time for the students. Although some steps were taken in 2019, nevertheless, urgent systemic reforms are needed to resolve legal and practical issues that hinder the full realization of the right to education. Source 2019 Annual Report on the activities of the Human Rights Defender of the Republic of Armenia and the situation of protection of human rights and fundamental freedoms, available at <https://www.ombuds.am/images/files/15b2661f76d10eb07746d7d4d4dec84f.pdf> (in Armenian)

□ Ad hoc public report "On commitments under the convention under the rights of the child and its optional protocols: The state of fulfillment by Armenia". In 2018, the HRD published an "Ad hoc public report on commitments under the convention under the rights of the child and its optional protocols: The state of fulfillment by Armenia" with the support of the UNICEF Armenia. Within the sphere of education, the Report addressed the following main issues with regard to

□ education of children with disabilities living in child care institutions and rural areas and

□ issues with regard to general educational training (such as improving the infrastructures of pre-primary schools and general education institutions, quality of education and demand for professional teachers, the percentage rate of drop-outs from schools after basic education). The report with concrete recommendations was presented to all relevant stakeholders. Source Ad hoc public report on commitments under the convention under the rights of the child and its optional protocols: The state of fulfillment by Armenia, available at <https://www.ombuds.am/images/files/99fc332f4fba0afea8721eb94edb6366.pdf> (in English)

H2 Please indicate which types of activities are available that promote international co-operation at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Hosting of international meetings on GCED and/or ESD	9	1	9	1
Participation in international meetings abroad on GCED and/or ESD	9	1	9	9
Support for programmes hosting foreign students, researchers and/or teachers	9	1	1	9
Membership of international networks including ASPnet	9	9	9	9
Joint research projects on GCED and/or ESD with foreign institutions	9	9	9	9
Other activities (please specify):				

I. Any other comments

- 11 Please indicate whether your country has faced any constraints, in particular related to global or national crises, including natural disasters, in implementing the 1974 Recommendation during the reporting period.

Challenges to the enjoyment of the right to education in the condition of COVID-19

On 16 March 2020, the Armenian Government approved the Decree "On declaring a state of emergency in the Republic of Armenia" in response to the outbreak of the novel coronavirus (COVID-19) in the world and in Armenia.

Since the first COVID-19 case has been reported in the Republic of Armenia, the HRDO started operating in a 24/7 regime and a special working group within the HRDO was established. The aim of the WG is to operatively and rapidly response to the emergency calls received through the hotline, conduct relevant monitoring, etc.

One of the issues raised concerned the organization of distance learning for children with special educational needs. During the State of Emergency, citizens applied to the HRD, expressing their concern that their children could not exercise their right to education. In particular, children with special educational needs faced issues not only because of their social status but also due to challenges in accessing distance learning. Hence, in case of distance learning, children with special educational needs (including children with physical or mental disability) become more vulnerable. Another issue was raised with regard to the accessibility of learning materials for children with disabilities: not all the materials were accessible to organize the distance learning.

The HRDO also received complaints with regard to issues on organizing distance learning for children from socially vulnerable families. In particular, the applicants informed that due to poor social conditions, they were unable to provide children with a computer, which results in the denial of the children's right to receive education. In this regard, it is necessary to be guided by the best interests of the child to ensure that every child has the opportunity to exercise their right to education.

The HRD, acting as an independent body monitoring the implementation of the provisions of the UN Convention on the Rights of the Child, initiated the monitoring of the process of organizing basic general education programs through distance learning. To solve this issue, the HRD cooperated with the Commandant's Office and Armenian Ministry of Education, Science, Culture and Sports. As a result of co-operation between the Human Rights Defender and the Commandant's Office, several families were provided with tablets for accessing distance learning programs. There is also a lack of relevant distance learning skills among teachers and learners, and lack of access to internet/ITC in remote rural areas.

Conflict on Nagorno-Karabakh

In 2020 schools and kindergarten in some border villages of the Republic of Armenia were shelled by the Azerbaijani military. In July the preschool of Aygepar village and the secondary school of Chinari village were targeted and heavily damaged by the Azerbaijani military. In October over the course of the Azerbaijani full-scale military attack on Nagorno-Karabakh, the Vardenis town and neighbouring areas of the Republic of Armenia were also subjected to missile and drone attacks conducted by the Azerbaijani armed forces which resulted in the temporary closure of all schools and educational institutions in the region.

- 12 Please provide any other relevant information or clarifications regarding the implementation of the 1974 Recommendation or the mainstreaming of GCED and ESD in your country's education system.